

User Experience Design

Lab Report



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I. Introduction User Personas

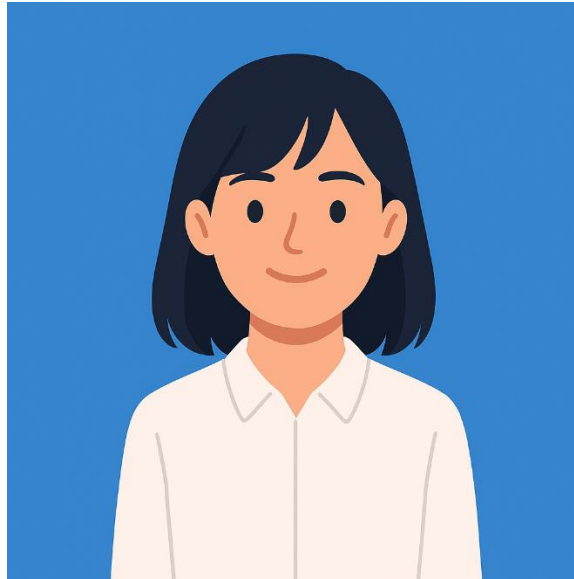
1. Persona 1 — General News Reader (Free User)



Category	Details
Name	Alex Vo
Age	22
Occupation / Income	Media & Communication Student; Part-time café staff (Low income)
Education	Bachelor’s Degree (in progress)
Location	Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam
Preferred Travel Destinations	Likes traveling to nearby beaches and popular tourist cities like Da Nang, Nha Trang.
Personality	Curious, social, easily influenced by trends, but wants reliable information.
Motivations	Wants to stay updated quickly and share interesting news with friends.
Interests / Hobbies	Watching tech reviews, social media browsing, gaming, hanging out in cafés.
Other Apps Used	TikTok, Facebook, Instagram, Zalo, Reddit.
Gadgets Used	Android smartphone, laptop (for university assignments), wireless earbuds.

Category	Details
Dislikes / Frustrations	Fake news, clickbait headlines, messy interfaces that are difficult to navigate.

2. Persona 2 — Professional Premium Subscriber



Category	Details
Name	Sophia Tran
Age	29
Occupation / Income	Freelance Journalist / Content Writer (Moderate to High income)
Education	Bachelor's Degree in Journalism
Location	Hanoi, Vietnam
Preferred Travel Destinations	Likes traveling abroad, especially to countries with cultural history (South Korea, Japan).
Personality	Analytical, detail-oriented, fast-paced, values accuracy and efficiency.
Motivations	Needs credible, up-to-date , and ad-free news to stay competitive in her work.
Interests / Hobbies	Reading long-form articles, interviewing people, café workspaces, documentary films.
Other Apps Used	Twitter/X, LinkedIn, Notion, Medium, Google News.
Gadgets Used	iPhone, MacBook Air, noise-canceling headphones.
Dislikes / Frustrations	Slow news updates, intrusive ads, unreliable sources, unorganized article categories.

3. Persona 3 — Accessibility-Focused User (Deaf User)



Category	Details
Name	Daniel Le
Age	34
Occupation / Income	Customer Support Agent (Stable medium income)
Education	Vocational College Graduates
Location	Da Nang, Vietnam
Preferred Travel Destinations	Prefers peaceful places such as Hội An or mountain areas.
Personality	Independent, adaptive, values clarity and simplicity in communication.
Motivations	Wants equal access to news without relying on audio; wants to stay informed socially.
Interests / Hobbies	Reading blogs, photography, attending community meetups, swimming.
Other Apps Used	YouTube (with captions), Messenger, Instagram, Telegram, VNExpress.
Gadgets Used	Android smartphone, smartwatch (for vibration notifications), tablet for reading.
Dislikes / Frustrations	Video news without subtitles, sound-only notifications, unclear UI labels, unclear text formatting.

II. User Scenarios

Scenario 1 — Alex Vo (General News Reader, Free User)

Story:

Alex is a 22-year-old media student who checks the news daily on his smartphone. He likes staying informed about technology, entertainment, and viral trends but often feels overwhelmed by irrelevant or unreliable sources.

On his way to university, Alex opens the **BuddyNews** app. The **AI News Curator** instantly displays short, trending articles about tech innovations and digital culture. He saves one article to read later and reacts to another by commenting in a discussion thread with friends. The integrated social feature allows him to engage with peers who share similar interests.

Goals:

- Stay updated quickly with relevant, trustworthy news.
- Interact socially with others about trending topics.

Expectations:

Alex expects the app to provide **personalized and reliable content**, an intuitive interface, and a smooth reading experience without unnecessary complexity.

Scenario 2 — Sophia Tran (Professional Premium User)

Story (Premium Feature Focus):

Sophia, a 29-year-old freelance journalist, relies on fast, accurate information for her writing. She subscribes to the **Premium plan** to access exclusive content and AI-powered tools.

While preparing an article on Southeast Asian market trends, Sophia activates **BuddyNews Premium**. The app's **AI Research Assistant** automatically compiles verified data, cross-checks facts from multiple sources, and provides a concise summary. She listens to a relevant podcast directly in the app and bookmarks quotes for citation. With **ad-free browsing** and **offline downloads**, she completes her research efficiently and publishes ahead of schedule.

Goals:

- Access credible, fast, and ad-free information for professional use.
- Integrate multiple media formats (text, podcast, AI summaries) seamlessly.

Expectations:

Sophia expects **accuracy, speed, and seamless multitasking**, as well as a **premium-quality experience** that supports her productivity.

Scenario 3 — Daniel Le (Accessibility-Focused User, Deaf)

Story:

Daniel is a 34-year-old customer support agent with hearing impairment. He enjoys following podcasts and video news but often struggles with a lack of captions or visual accessibility features.

During his lunch break, Daniel opens **BuddyNews** and enables the **AI Accessibility Mode**. The app automatically generates **real-time subtitles** for news videos and **text summaries** for live radio shows. When a breaking news podcast is released, he receives a **vibration notification** instead of a sound alert. He comfortably reads transcripts and engages with posts through comments, feeling fully included in the media experience.

Goals:

- Access news and podcasts in a fully visual, captioned format.
- Participate equally in online discussions.

Expectations:

Daniel expects an **inclusive interface**, accurate subtitles, and consistent visual alerts that replace audio cues.

III. User Requirements (MoSCoW Method)

1. Must Have (Essential Requirements)

Feature	Description
User Registration & Login	Allow users to sign up via email or social media accounts to create profiles.
Personalized News Feed (AI)	AI algorithm recommends news, podcasts, and media content based on user interests.
Search & Filter System	Users can search for specific news topics, podcasts, or music genres.

Feature	Description
Multimedia Content Integration	Support for articles, videos, podcasts, and music streams in a single app.
Basic Social Interaction	Users can react, comment, and share articles within the Buddy social network.
Accessibility Options	Provide large text, dark mode, captions, and text summaries for inclusive access.
Push Notifications	Send visual and vibration alerts for breaking news.
Secure Data Protection	Protect user data through encryption and privacy compliance.

2. Should Have (Important but Not Critical)

Feature	Description
Saved Articles & Playlists	Users can bookmark news or create custom podcast/music playlists.
AI Summarization Tool	AI automatically generates article and audio summaries for quick reading.
User Community & Discussion Threads	Discussion sections for users to exchange opinions on trending topics.
Cross-Platform Sync	Sync data and preferences across multiple devices.
Content Reporting System	Users can report misinformation or inappropriate content.

3. Could Have (Optional Enhancements)

Feature	Description
Voice Command Interaction	AI assistant supports voice-based control for reading news or switching sections.
Gamification Elements	Reward system for daily reading or sharing content.
Collaborative Playlists	Users can share and co-create podcast/music playlists.
Offline Reading Mode (Limited)	Allow limited offline access for saved content in free version.

4. Won't Have (Currently Excluded)

Feature	Description
Live Video Streaming	Not included in the current version due to high resource demands.
User Monetization (Content Creator Earnings)	Will be considered in future updates after platform maturity.

Feature	Description
Complex Custom Themes	Advanced UI personalization is not essential for MVP release.

Premium Features (Additional Requirements)

Category	Feature	Description
Content Access	Ad-Free Experience	Removes all banner and video advertisements.
AI Intelligence	Advanced AI Summarization & Insights	Deep analysis and summary for professional use (e.g., journalists).
Audio & Podcast	Offline Downloads	Listen to podcasts and music offline.
Personalization	Priority Source Filtering	Option to choose verified or premium news sources only.
Notifications	Real-Time Breaking News Alerts	Faster, exclusive notifications for major news events.
Support & Upgrades	Early Access to New Features	Premium users get beta access to future app functions.

IV. Hierarchical Task Analysis Flowcharts

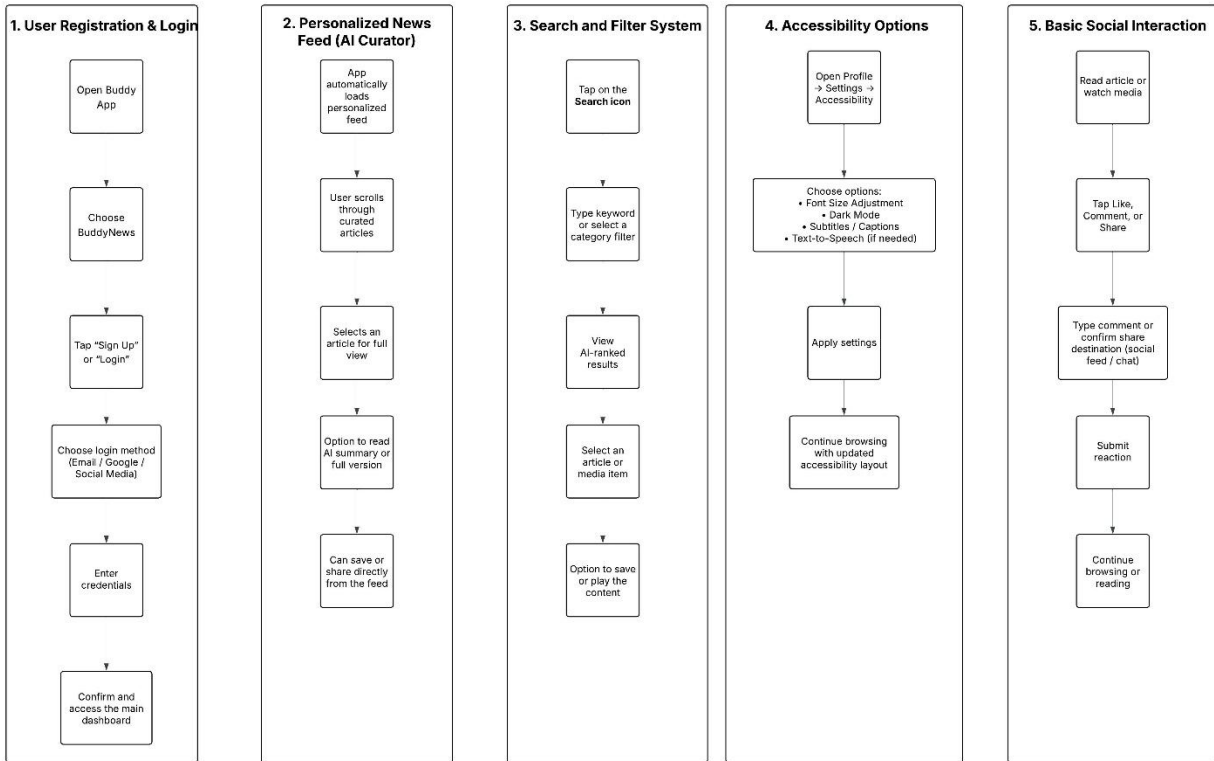


Figure X: HTA Flowcharts for Must-Have Features

1. [HTA Overview](#)

HTA was applied to deconstruct the app’s **“Must Have” features** into a series of structured subtasks that represent the logical sequence of user actions. These include:

1. **User Registration & Login**
2. **Personalised News Feed (AI Curator)**
3. **Search and Filter System**
4. **Accessibility Options**
5. **Basic Social Interaction**

Each task diagram visualises how users progress through the interface — from launching the app to engaging with content — while highlighting the most critical decision points and user pathways.

2. [HTA Flowcharts](#)

(Figure X above illustrates the five HTA flowcharts for the “Must Have” features.)

The **User Registration & Login** flow focuses on fast and flexible onboarding, offering multiple sign-in methods (email, Google, or social media) to reduce friction during entry. The **Personalised News Feed** uses AI algorithms to generate relevant content, ensuring that users can view, read, and save articles directly from their feed.

The **Search and Filter System** provides efficient keyword and category-based discovery, while the **Accessibility Options** enable users to tailor the interface using font size adjustment, dark mode, and text-to-speech features. Finally, the **Basic Social Interaction** flow encourages engagement through reactions, comments, and content sharing within the app's social network.

3. Discussion and Insights

Through this hierarchical breakdown, each essential function of BuddyNews is clearly represented in terms of user action and system response. This structured analysis supports a **user-centred design approach**, helping designers identify potential usability issues and optimise task flow.

By visualising user interactions in sequence, the HTA provides a practical foundation for **prototyping and usability testing**, ensuring that future design iterations align with the app's goals of **simplicity, accessibility, and engagement**.

4. Conclusion

The HTA process effectively demonstrates how BuddyNews supports efficient and inclusive user interaction. By mapping out these core user journeys, the design team can ensure that all “Must Have” features are intuitive and cohesive, forming the foundation for an enhanced user experience in both the free and premium versions of the application.